

Juanita the Ice Maiden

In 1995, an Inca girl aged 11–15 was found on Mount Ampato, Peru. The discoverers named her Juanita, or the “Ice Maiden.” She was sacrificed to the gods about 530 years ago. The cold had preserved her skin, organs, blood, and stomach contents.

James Hepburn,
4th Earl of Bothwell
Denmark, 1578

Charles Eugène de Croÿ
Estonia, 1702

Vladimir Lenin
Russia, 1924

Georgi Dimitrov
Bulgaria, 1949

Dröbnitz Girl
Poland, 650 BCE

Valley of the Golden Mummies
Egypt, 332 BCE–395 CE

Maronite mummies
Lebanon, 1283

Chehrabad Salt Mine mummies
Iran, 4th century BCE–4th century CE

Iufaa and family
Egypt, c. 500 BCE

Saqqara mummies
Egypt, 640 BCE

Nubian mummies
Sudan, 250–1400

Tarim mummies
China, 1800–200 BCE

Siberian Ice Maiden
Russia, c. 400 BCE

Pazyryk ice mummies
Mongolia, c. 700–200 BCE

Mao Zedong
China, 1976

Xin Zhui
China, c. 150 BCE

Ho Chi Minh
Vietnam, 1969

Mummy monk “Luang Phor Daeng”
Thailand, c. 1985

Vu Khắc Minh and Vu Khắc Truong
Vietnam, c. 1600–1700

Chiang Kai-shek and Chiang Ching-kuo
Taiwan, 1975 and 1988

Buddhist self-mummified nun and monks
Taiwan, 1680–1830,

Fujiwara clan mummies
Japan, 1128–1189

Kim Il-Sung and Kim Jong-il
North Korea, 1994 and 2011

Korean mummies
South Korea, c. 1350–1500

Lost mummies of New Guinea
Papua New Guinea, up to 1950s

MUMMY DISCOVERIES WORLDWIDE

Some mummies are discovered singly, often in remote locations such as in peat bogs or on high mountains. Other finds involve larger numbers of mummies—for example, in communal graves, tombs, caves, or catacombs.



Accidental mummies



Intentional mummies

Number of mummies

0–19

20–39

40–59

60–79

80–99

100–119

120–139

140+

Mummies

Mummies—the preserved bodies of the dead—have been found the world over. Many were made deliberately, while others formed naturally. More recently, some countries have mummified their leaders.

3 Mummies of Palermo

In 1599, Christian monks in Palermo, Sicily, began to mummify their dead and stored them in catacombs. Later, rich people paid the monks to mummify their bodies.

4 Self-mummified monks

From 1680–1830, some Buddhist monks in Japan mummified themselves. They starved, drank special tea to make their body toxic to maggots, and then were sealed alive in a stone tomb.

5 Chinchorro mummies

The Chinchorro, who lived in what is now Chile and Peru, were the first people known to make mummies. Their oldest mummies date from as early as 5000 BCE.

THE PALERMO
**CATACOMBS CONTAIN
ABOUT 8,000 MUMMIES**